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UNIVERSITY OF GHANA
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DEPARTMENT OF TEACHER EDUCATION
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP
COLLEGES OF EDUCATION
END OF SEMESTER ONE EXAMINATIONS FOR LEVEL 300, 2024/2025
B.ED. PROGRAMME

COURSE CODE: TEEG 305/TEUP 309
COURSE TITLE: CHILDREN'S LITERATURE

Instruction: Answer **all** questions in Section A and any **three** questions in Section B.

Time: 2 hours

SECTION A

[25 Marks]

Answer **all** the questions in this section.

1. Which of the following elements must be consistently present in children's literature?
   A. Anthropomorphic characters
   B. Happy endings only
   C. Moral lessons in every story
   D. Relevance to children's experiences and interests

2. How does children's literature contribute to cognitive development?
   A. By focusing solely on educational content
   B. By limiting exposure to complex ideas
   C. By presenting challenges within children's grasp
   D. By simplifying all concepts

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3. When selecting culturally responsive reading materials, which of the following should guide the teacher's decision-making?
   A. Prioritize books from international publishers for higher quality content
   B. Use stories that reflect children's cultural backgrounds and lived experiences
   C. Focus mainly on books that promote national pride and historical facts
   D. Choose books that avoid local references to maintain neutrality

4. Which of the following misconceptions about children's literature is the <u>most</u> prevalent?
   A. It develops critical thinking skills.
   B. It must always teach explicit moral lessons.
   C. It requires careful crafting.
   D. It supports emotional development.

5. Which of the following statements represents a valid understanding of the scope of children's literature?
   A. It encompasses only fiction for young readers.
   B. It includes various genres and formats suitable for children.
   C. It must avoid complex themes entirely.
   D. It should focus solely on educational content.

6. What role should parents play in developing children's literary appreciation?
   a. Focus only on educational books
   b. Leave it to teachers entirely
   c. Model reading enjoyment and engagement
   d. Purchase books without discussion

7. A teacher is designing a storybook for early readers in a multilingual classroom. Which of the following practices will best promote both comprehension and cultural relevance in the storybook?
   A. Using complex English vocabulary with moral lessons
   B. Including short, rhyming poems with abstract ideas
   C. Incorporating local settings, familiar characters, and home language where possible
   D. Adapting popular western stories to local school settings while maintaining the original language

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8. Which of the following approaches best supports children's literature appreciation?
   A. Enforcing daily reading quotas
   B. Focusing only on classics
   C. Providing diverse reading choices
   D. Requiring book reports

9. Which of the following approaches best addresses the challenge of limited access to children's literature in underserved communities?
   A. Creating digital libraries and mobile reading programmes
   B. Increasing book prices to fund more publications
   C. Limiting access to specific hours only
   D. Reducing the variety of available books

10. Which of the following approaches is the most effective in addressing the challenge of maintaining children's interest in literature
    A. Enforcing strict reading schedules
    B. Including interactive and multimedia elements
    C. Limiting book choices to classics only
    D. Using only text-heavy materials

11. What is the most crucial aspect of assessing a child's literature comprehension skills?
    A. Comparing scores with other students
    B. Focusing solely on reading speed
    C. Measuring multiple aspects of understanding
    D. Testing vocabulary in isolation

12. Why is continuous assessment of children's literature skills important?
    A. It helps in grade assignment only
    B. It identifies learning gaps and progress
    C. It reduces teaching time
    D. It simplifies lesson planning

13. A culturally insensitive storybook describes traditional food as "weird" and local names as "funny." What is the most responsible step a teacher should take?
    A. Use the story to initiate a debate about humor in literature
    B. Ignore the language and focus on the book's grammatical structure
    C. Set the book aside and seek more culturally respectful alternatives
    D. Assign the story as reading homework and discuss it only if students raise concerns

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14. Which of the following aspects is most crucial when creating literature materials for early readers?
    A. Aesthetic appeal
    B. Complex vocabulary
    C. Length of text
    D. Visual and textual balance

15. When selecting supplementary reading materials for early grades, which of the following factors is most crucial?
    A. Aesthetic appeal of the cover
    B. Cost-effectiveness of the materials
    C. Reading level appropriateness
    D. Size of the text

16. What makes illustrations effective in supporting comprehension?
    A. Abstract artistic style
    B. Alignment with text content
    C. Decorative purposes only
    D. Minimal use of images

17. A teacher gives students short story excerpts followed by open-ended questions that ask them to predict endings. What skill is primarily being assessed?
    A. Fluency
    B. Literal comprehension
    C. Critical thinking
    D. Word recognition

18. Which of the following points is the best way to represent disabilities in children's books?
    A. As primary plot points only
    B. Natural inclusion in various stories
    C. Only in special needs books
    D. Through stereotypical challenges

19. Which of the following assessment tools is most appropriate to check students' appreciation of literature?
    A. Reading speed timer
    B. Standardized grammar test
    C. Story dramatization
    D. Multiple-choice spelling quiz

20. What of the following options is the best way to portray gender roles in professional contexts within children's books?
    A. Avoiding professional contexts
    B. Following traditional stereotypes
    C. Showing diverse career choices
    D. Using only gender-neutral jobs

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21. What is the most effective use of colour in children's books?
    A. Black and white only
    B. Bright colours exclusively
    C. Muted, pastel tones only
    D. Purpose-driven colour choices

22. When developing literature materials for early grade children, a teacher includes colourful illustrations, simple sentence structures, and repetition. This approach is primarily intended to_____.
    A. Reduce the need for guided reading
    B. Enhance children's cognitive development through grammar
    C. Develop children's decoding skills and sustained interest
    D. Avoid curriculum overload

23. Which of the following strategies would best help a teacher assess a child's ability to make inferences from a story?
    A. Oral retelling with visual aids
    B. Matching vocabulary with pictures
    C. Selecting the title from multiple options
    D. Explaining a character's motive using story clues

24. During literature lessons, a teacher integrates drawing, singing, and storytelling games. What is the most likely impact of this strategy on children's engagement with literature?
    A. It enhances learners' creativity and emotional connection to texts.
    B. It replaces the need for structured reading and comprehension activities.
    C. It distracts learners from the core academic objectives of literature.
    D. It limits the use of print-based materials in the classroom.

25. A teacher uses expressive reading, pauses for discussion, and encourages students to share personal responses to a story. What learning outcome does this approach most effectively promote?
    A. Improved memorisation of literary terms and definitions
    B. Development of critical thinking and personal connection to texts
    C. Mastery of pronunciation and sentence structure through oral reading
    D. Focused attention on correct pronunciation and fluency drills

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SECTION B

[75 Marks]

Answer any **three** questions in this section.

1. a) What is children's literature? [5 Marks]
   b) Discuss four (4) significance of children's literature in early childhood education. Illustrate your points with relevant examples. [20 Marks]

2. a) List five (5) major characteristics of children's literature. [5 Marks]
   b) Discuss how any four (4) of these characteristics influence the selection of texts for classroom use. [20 Marks]

3. a) Explain the concept of inclusivity in children's literature. [5 Marks]
   b) Discuss four (4) ways by which inclusive texts influence learners' self-perception and classroom engagement. [20 Marks]

4. a) Enumerate five (5) importance of assessing children's literature skills? [5 Marks]
   b) Discuss four (4) assessment strategies and how they support literacy development in young learners. [20 Marks]

5. a) Mention five (5) key principles a teacher should consider in preparing literature materials for early grade learners. [5 Marks]
   b) Discuss how any four (4) of these principles contribute to effective teaching and learning. [20 Marks]